

endangered Saharan cheetah were found in the mountains in 2006, and there is a population of Dorcas gazelles in the area.

Kapsiki Peak

Location The Mandara Mountains, northern Cameroon

Close to the village of Rhumski in the volcanic Mandara Mountains, a series of sentinel-like volcanic plugs rise sheer from the grassland. The tallest of them is Kapsiki Peak, which rises to 4,016 ft (1,224 m) above sea level. The plug formed when lava cooled and solidified as resistant rock in a volcano’s vent. Subsequent

erosion removed the less-resistant volcanic cone, leaving behind just the hard plug.

Lake Nyos

Location Northwest Cameroon

Situated on the flank of an extinct volcano, Lake Nyos is one of only three “exploding lakes” in the world. Its deep waters are saturated with carbon dioxide (CO₂) from a pocket of magma deep underground. On August 21, 1986, when the lake’s waters were disturbed by a landslide, the gas rose into areas of lower pressure, bubbled out of solution, and

escaped. A massive cloud of CO₂—about ¼ cubic mile (1 cubic km)—poured down the mountainside and suffocated 1,746 people in the valley below.

Pico Cão Grande

Location Near the southern end of São Tomé island, São Tomé and Príncipe

Also known as Great Dog Peak, this moss-covered column of rock on the island of São Tomé rises 1,198 ft (365 m) above the surrounding landscape and 2,192 ft (668 m) above sea level. It is a volcanic plug, which formed when magma solidified in the vent of an active volcano. The

volcano’s cone has subsequently been eroded, and volcanic activity has long since ceased in the area.

The Ethiopian Highlands

Location The Horn of Africa, mostly central and northern Ethiopia

This range is called the roof of Africa for a good reason: it is the largest area above 4,900 ft (1,500 m) on the continent, and its highest peak, Ras Dashen, rises to 14,928 ft (4,550 m). The source of the Blue Nile, Lake Tana, is in the highlands. Bisected by the East African Rift Valley, they are also home to



▲ CLIFFS AND ESCARPMENTS IN THE ETHIOPIAN HIGHLANDS